



**MOST OF** Gaza’s 2.1 million people live west of the Yellow Line, in territory still subject to daily Israeli attacks.

ALI JADALLAH Anadolu

## Iran bets time’s on its side in war

Tehran believes it can take the pain longer than the U.S., and win more concessions.

By JOSEPH KRAUSS AND AMIR-HUSSEIN RADJY

The Strait of Hormuz is, by some accounts, named for a Zoroastrian deity destined to emerge victorious after a 9,000-year standoff with an adversary.

Iran’s leaders feel their own victory is at hand and won’t require the same epic patience.

They are betting that military pressure will ultimately force the United States to accept their control over the crucial waterway for global energy — and that time is on their side.

They know about the diminishing stockpiles of key U.S. weapons such as advanced missile interceptors. They know the war is deeply unpopular with Americans. They know that as long as the strait is largely closed, the price of gas and other goods will stay high ahead of U.S. congressional elections in November. They know that trying to open it by force would be costly and may require American ground troops. They know their Houthi allies in Yemen could widen the war and disrupt another major trade route.

By that logic, President Trump has no choice but to capitulate.

But Iran’s strategy [See Iran, A6]

### Iran issues new set of demands

Tehran says it will not reopen Strait of Hormuz until the U.S. “corrects its behavior.” **WORLD, A3**

## AN ENCROACHING BORDER IN GAZA

Since October’s ceasefire, Israel has shifted its Yellow Line west, further displacing thousands

By NABIH BULOS AND BILAL SHBEIR

DEIR AL BALAH, Gaza Strip — Every day for the last three months, he had looked at it. And for every day of the last three months he had ignored it, even as it moved ever closer.

But now the Yellow Line — the demarcation indicating the limit of Israel’s military zone in Gaza — was barely 100 yards from Ashraf Al-Louh’s shelter. It was time to leave.

Many people around him had already done so, and every day saw more people join the exodus from this war-blighted neighborhood in the city of Deir al Balah. The Israeli military marks the Yellow Line with large yellow-painted concrete blocks and has moved them westward as it occupies more and more territory.

As Al-Louh spoke, a donkey cart with three elderly women and two elderly men as passengers came into view. It creaked past his shelter, past the collapsed buildings and ravaged orchards toward the

west, away from the Yellow Line. The passengers’ extra clothing was wrapped in a mattress cover, and in the center of the group stood a few cans of beans and two sacks of flour — all their remaining possessions.

“We’re exhausted. We’ve already been displaced seven times,” said Al-Louh, 45, his eyes following the donkey cart before glancing eastward toward the yellow blocks.

The Yellow Line first came to be in October 2025, when Israel and Hamas signed a Trump administration-brokered truce and Israeli troops withdrew from some territory as part of the ceasefire’s first phase.

Though the line has not been recognized by the United Nations or other international organizations as a legal border, it effectively divides the enclave into two zones: an eastern one controlled by [See Gaza, A4]

## Beautiful downtown Burbank — for real

It’s not just a punchline. The city center is booming as L.A. struggles.

By Roger Vincent



DAVID BUTOW For The Times

**BURBANK** says it embraces business while working to expand housing. Free parking doesn’t hurt either.

A Burbank landlord trying to land a trendy ice cream shop tenant got a critical assist from the city that helped seal the deal.

When a Van Leeuwen Ice Cream representative came to look at his space in the center of downtown Burbank in April, a senior city official was there to help woo the brand, said Kurt Kaufman of West Coast Investors, which owns the property.

“She said, ‘Look, guys, we aren’t the city of L.A. We can make things happen,’” he recalled. “They were able to open in quite record speed.”

Van Leeuwen had expected to have to wait until next year, but was able to open its doors in time for peak ice cream season, summer, in part because of the city’s help.

While downtown Los Angeles is languishing, Burbank is booming.

Its secret formula, the city says, is embracing businesses, helping the homeless and keeping streets clean, to make downtown a [See Burbank, A14]

## Homelessness in I10 corridor challenges Bass

Mayor’s Inside Safe teams keep visiting the same area, often with little progress.

By DAVID ZAHNISER

Abigail Aguirre has been sleeping terribly.

Too many times, she said, residents of a nearby homeless encampment have partied late into the night — sometimes yelling, sometimes blasting music. The noise is especially hard on her husband, who frequently leaves for his job before 5 a.m.

“Oh my God, they don’t let us sleep,” said Aguirre, whose home sits just east of the I10 Freeway in South Los Angeles. “They do drugs in there. They play the loud music. They don’t care.”

Three years ago, workers with Mayor Karen Bass’ Inside Safe program moved dozens of homeless people from Aguirre’s neighborhood into nearby hotels and motels. Sanitation crews cleared the streets and side-

walks of trash.

But more people, and their tents, kept arriving, not just near Aguirre’s home but on many of the east-west streets that pass over the I10 south of downtown: 43rd, 49th, 51st and Vernon Avenue, to name a few.

Unsheltered homelessness — people living on the street or in their vehicles — went up nearly 8% citywide in this year’s homeless count, dealing a setback to Bass, who is running for reelection and has made homelessness a core part of her agenda.

The streets that line the I10 Freeway between 42nd and 58th are a potent symbol of the challenges facing Bass and her program. According to records obtained by The Times, outreach workers carried out Inside Safe operations 25 times on that one-mile stretch during her first three years as mayor, returning again and again to bring people indoors.

During one operation, Inside Safe brought 42 people inside. A month later, 54 more people came indoors. [See Inside Safe, A11]

## Uncharted threat to California’s coast

White House wants to decertify the state’s longtime power to protect its shoreline.

By ROSANNA XIA

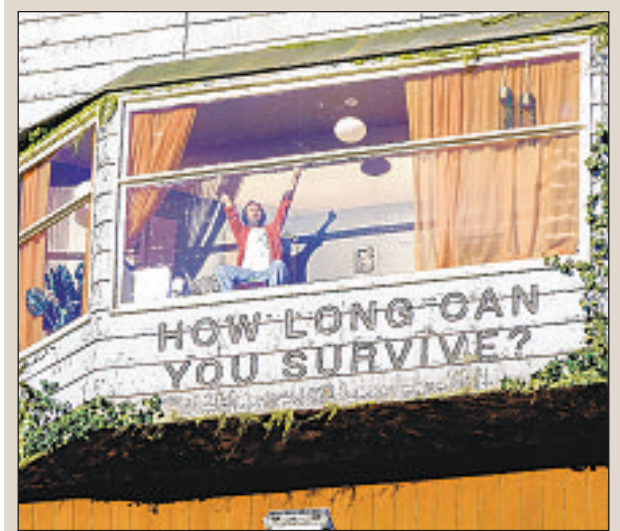
For months, the Trump administration has sought to open the California coast to a radically industrialized future: large-scale desalination plants, floating nuclear reactors, more rocket launches and expanded offshore oil drilling along the state’s most iconic beaches.

Holding the line against all this is a little-known but long-standing federal law, the Coastal Zone Management Act, which grants coastal states like California the right to review and object to any project in federal waters that clashes with state policy.

Now, citing California’s “environmental extrem-

ism,” Trump officials are attempting to decertify the state’s power under this law. Framed as a performance review of the state’s coastal management practices, this challenge begins in earnest Monday during a public hearing in Santa Monica, where hundreds of emboldened regulators, elected officials, environmentalists, Indigenous leaders, community activists and everyday Californians are expected to speak out.

The review will be conducted by the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration’s Office for Coastal Management and comes amid federal efforts to dismantle clean air policies, endangered species protections and other landmark environmental regulations that have long drawn the ire of industry and fossil fuel producers. In California, efforts to override environmental protections have [See Threat, A10]



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

### HE’S ON BOARD

Above Sunset Boulevard, Netflix promotes a new film with a man in a billboard ADU of sorts, drawing curiosity near and far. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

### Lake Mead hits record low level

The reservoir on the Colorado has dropped farther than at any time since it was filled in 1935. **NATION, A10**

### Weather

Lots of sun; warm. L.A. Basin: 92/70. **B8**

**Business** ..... **A12**  
**Opinion Voices** ..... **A16**

### A salute to L.A.’s great neighbors

Readers share stories of everyday heroes who make a neighborhood a home. **WEEKEND, L6**

For the latest news, go to **latimes.com**.



## With smart glasses, many see privacy issues

By QUEENIE WONG

Meta wants its smart glasses to be a big hit, but the high-tech specs have also turned into a liability, as some are calling the gadget “pervert glasses.”

The social media giant dominates the market for smart glasses, which allow people to capture photos and videos, listen to music, take phone calls and ask questions of an artificial intelligence assistant.

Some people are using

the glasses — which look like a pair of regular spectacles — to record people without their knowledge and publish the videos on social media.

The users secretly videotape and share what happens when they try to pick up women. Now, a growing number of people are worried they could be covertly recorded at the gym or even during sex.

While Meta’s glasses have a flashing white light on their frames to notify people they’re being recorded, some users have been hiding

or disabling the light by hiring people to drill into their eyewear so they can record in stealth.

The backlash has prompted Meta to update its glasses to address privacy concerns, and some places have banned them, adding to the angst surrounding technology that’s rapidly evolving. It’s too early to tell whether the criticism will dent sales of smart glasses, said Jitesh Ubrani, a director at the market research company IDC.

“A headline cycle like this

is exactly the kind of thing that could slow momentum with mainstream buyers, even if early adopters don’t blink,” he said.

Artificial intelligence seems to be popping up everywhere, fueling the advancement of hardware beyond the smartphone but also debate about its use.

“We’re at a very sensitive time for the tech industry in terms of trying to really preserve that positive consumer sentiment that’s taking a bit of a hit due to AI, [See Glasses, A11]